Chapter 3

GLORY AND GUTS



"One individual may die for an idea, but that idea will, after his death, incarnate itself in a thousand lives."

- Subhas Chandra Bose

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Discuss the glorious achievements of the Cholas under Rajaraja Chola and his successors
- Examine the social and political scenario when Muhammad Ghori attacks Bharat
- Identify the Bharatiya rulers from different regions who resisted the tyrants like Muhammad Ghori, Qutbuddin Aibak and more
- Discuss the outcome and impact of the significant battles

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INTRODUCTION

Even as invasions in northern Bharat affected the nation, few portions in the north and most of southern Bharat were largely unaffected. Almost 70% of the country carried on with their usual way of life where the Dharmashastras were followed, and Hinduism flourished. Regional pride of the rulers ensured that arts, learning, and literature thrived. The Chaulukyas, Eastern Chaulukyas, Eastern Gangas, Kakatiyas, Yadavas, Pandyas and Hoysalas were the major kingdoms that flourished between the 11th and 14th centuries in southern Bharat.

One of the greatest rulers in Bharat's history was laying the foundations of a glorious empire, which became be one of the most important kingdoms of that time in terms of its power, size, and cultural achievements. The ruler was Rajaraja Chola who expanded the Chola empire between 985 CE and 1014 CE.

In northern Bharat, the Ghaznavid dynasty was nearing its end and strong rulers of Bharat were able to thwart attacks. However, the Ghurids from Ghor started their vicious attacks on Bharat that would lead to a difficult time for Bharat.

MIGHTY CHOLAS - THEIR ACHIEVEMENTS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

RAJARAJA CHOLA ESTABLISHES A MIGHTY EMPIRE

The period between 980 CE and 1080 CE was glorious for the Cholas. The Chola empire was in a phase of expansion and consolidation. Rajaraja Chola (born Arulmozhi Varman) and his lineage greatly expanded their kingdom. Rooted in his culture, Rajaraja was one of the greatest patrons of art and architecture.

A COMPLETE SWEEP OF THE SOUTHERN KINGDOMS

On taking over the Chola kingdom in 985 CE, Rajaraja started expanding the Chola kingdom through conquests. The immediate threat in the south were the Cheras, Pandyas and Sinhalas who had formed an alliance to fight Rajaraja. He attacked Chera king Bhaskara Ravi Varman at Kandalur Salai, a coastal town in the Chera kingdom and won. Raja Amarabhujangan of the Pandyas was then defeated in battle and his territories were annexed. Regions like Kollam, Kodungaloor, Vizhinjam and Madurai were now under the Cholas.



Rajaraja Chola

GOING OVERSEAS

Mahinda V who was ruling Anuradhapura, Sri Lanka, was forced to retreat to south-western Sri Lanka due to internal problems. Rajaraja saw this as an opportunity and attacked Sri Lanka. Northern Sri Lanka was captured and included as a province of the Chola empire called Mumudi Chozha Mandalam. The capital of this province was Jagannathamangalam (present-day Polonnaruva).

A beautiful temple for Shiva was erected here that is still well preserved and outlines the glory of Chola architecture. Inscriptions that were found indicate that Rajaraja conquered "old islands of the sea numbering twelve thousand" which are present-day Lakshadweep and Maldives.

BATTLE OF ANURADHAPURA	
When? 993 CE	
Where? Anuradhapura	
Who were the combatants?	
Cholas	Sinhalas
Who were the commanders?	
Rajaraja Chola	Mahinda V
Outcome : Chola victory	
SIGNIFICANCE : Further expansion into southeast Asia with Ceylon as a base	

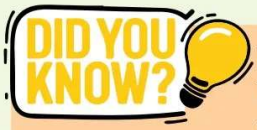
GOING NORTH

The regions in and around Mysore were conquered by Rajaraja but he met stiff resistance from the Western Chaulukyas led by Tailapa II. However, after the death of Tailapa II, Rajaraja through his alliances made sure that he expanded in the Mysore region. Soon Kalinga was captured by Rajaraja. When he assumed power, the Chola kingdom was negligible, constantly under attack from the Rashtrakutas. But Rajaraja through his valour, political acumen*, rightful conduct and military might made the empire into an invincible* empire. He went on to create an extensive, well-knit empire that went even beyond the seas. His empire was efficiently organized, well administered, nd tightly protected. Education, art and architecture flourished.

HIGHLIGHTS OF CHOLA RULE

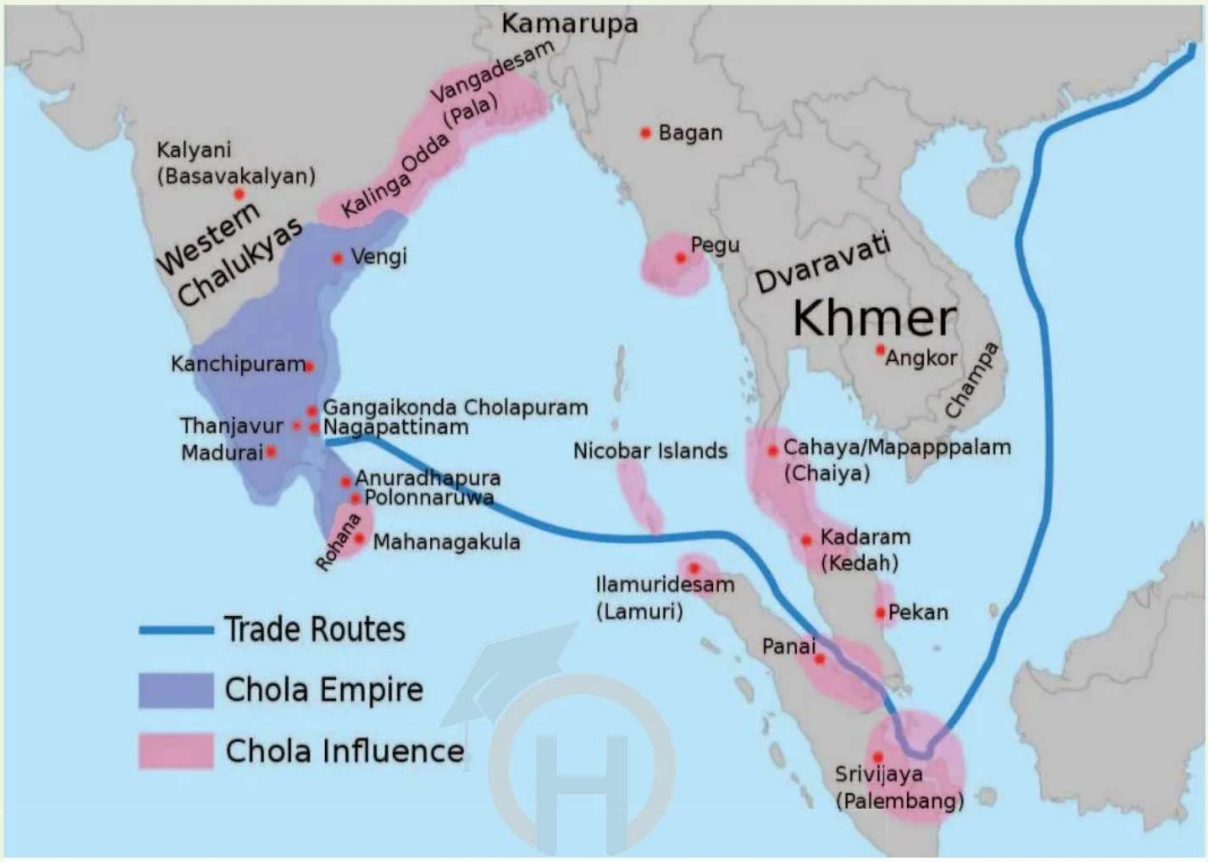
RELATIONSHIP WITH CHINA

Rajaraja was a visionary ruler who understood the importance of trade for a flourishing empire. Rajaraja sent a group of traders to China in 1015 CE. The relationships established continued even when Rajaraja's son Rajendra Chola took over the empire and even extended to his son Kulotunga Chola.



Travelling in mid-sea is always a challenge - high tides, rains & lightning, attack by pirates are common. Hence there are possibilities of loss of goods due to these reasons. In order to mitigate the unexpected loss, the goods are insured. This practice of insurance has been in place since the Vedic age!!!

Acumen : Ability to make good judgements **Invincible :** Too powerful to overcome



South-East Asia under Chola Empire

A PIONEERING NAVAL SUPERPOWER

The Cholas were truly pioneers in recognizing the importance of a strong navy. Their supreme authority in the seas went to the extent where the Bay of Bengal came to be called a 'Chola Lake'. Their empire came to include Sri Lanka, Nicobar islands, the Malay peninsula and Sumatra. Having a superior navy made sure that Bharat was able to exert considerable influence in overseas regions. Pagan and Kambuja (Cambodia) in southeast Asia, Java, Sumatra, Borneo and Bali were all kingdoms that formed part of Dvipantara Bharata (Bharat Beyond the Seas). Various classes of ships were designed and built.

They include :

Kattumaram - Typically logs of wood bound together primarily used for transporting goods from ships anchored in harbours to the shore.

Sangara - Medium-sized ships made of large logs of wood with steel in the sides for protection, to carry cargo

Colandia - Large ships to cross oceans on long voyages. They could hold hundreds of people and cargo

Besides these, there were warships that were also constructed and used by the Cholas. Rajendra Chola, son and successor to Rajaraja, further strengthened this naval fleet and went on to capture more regions in southeast Asia including Kadaram (present-day Malaysia). This led to him being called **Kadaram Kondaan** (the one who conquered Kadaram).



Model of Chola era ship hull reconstructed by ASI

The main ports around which the Cholas operated were Nagapattinam, Kadalur, Poompuhar and Thoothukudi. Further inland, there was a smaller fleet of ships maintained in Kanchipuram along the Palar river.

Astronomy and navigation are very important in the shipping trade. Astronomy and navigation were taught in universities in major regions like Madurai, Kanchi, Thanjavur and Tiruchirapalli. Inscriptions have been found detailing an astronomer called Suryadeva Dikshitha living around 1191 CE who has written detailed works on astronomy. Scholars of various parts of Bharat interacted in fields like astronomy and navigation. It is said that seafarers of the time had in-depth knowledge of almost 56 stars seen in the lower latitudes of the northern hemisphere.



Postage stamp released by Government of India

DID YOU KNOW?

From inscriptions and archaeological evidence, we understand that many navigation instruments were used by the Cholas. For navigation using the stars, a **Ra-palagai** was used. **Tappu-palagai** enabled measurements of speed. Palagai in Tamil means board. To measure the depth of water flat bronze plates were used and the human hand was used for understanding the altitude of stars. The study of weather, winds, and currents were an advanced skill that the Chola mariners possessed.

EXPERTS IN ADMINISTRATION

The Cholas understood the need for setting up an efficient administrative system and a lot of our current systems of governance have developed from them.

- The village was the smallest unit of administration. A Chola empire consisted of a group of villages called Kurrams (Tehsils). Many Kurrams made up a nadu or valanadu. Many nadus made up a mandala.
- During Rajaraja's time, there were around 8 to 9 mandalas. Every mandala was managed by an officer. There was an efficient hierarchy* of people in the governance of the land. Promotions of the people working for the government were given based on merit. This was even true for the princes of the land.
- Rajaraja understood that different layers of administration may lead to corruption and disconnect him from his people. Hence, the Chola king appointed an official called the Naduvirikkai. This person helped in communication between the citizens of the land and the king.
- Land revenue was the main source of income for the government. 17% was collected as tax. Other than land revenue, customs and tolls also brought income to the treasury. Since land revenue was critical, a massive land ownership survey was instituted by Rajaraja and continued by his successors. Various types of lands were measured and ownership information was documented. Any problem on ownership was resolved quickly If government lands were illegally occupied by common people or vice versa, a committee solved the disputes.

DID YOU KNOW?

Were the King's orders valid by itself?

Only when the respective officials in the administration signed off could orders become functional. It has been found that important government orders required about 40 different officials to sign off. This was to ensure that the orders were executed and monitored properly.

Hierarchy : A system that organises based on level of importance/power

KUDAVOLAI SYSTEM

Uttaramerur inscriptions bring to light the Kudavolai system. This system was a very notable and unique feature of the village administration of the Cholas. There were 30 wards in each village. A representative for each ward was elected through the Kudavolai system. Names of the contestants from whom one would be chosen were written on palm leaf tickets. These palm leaves were put into a pot and shuffled. A child picked up palm leaves one by one from the pot. Persons whose name tickets were picked up by the child were declared elected. Like this 30 members for thirty wards were elected. This kind of peculiar election system was called Kudavolai system. Out of the thirty elected members, twelve members were appointed to the Annual committee, twelve members to the Garden committee and six to the Tank committee. Members of the standing committee and a Gold committee were also elected.

Qualifications to apply and contest elections included :

1. The person should be between 35 and 70 years.
2. They should possess one veli (6.6 acres) of land and a house built on taxable land.
3. They should have knowledge of the Vedas and mantras.

People who were not qualified to contest elections included :

1. People who had killed cows, women, children and pious people.
2. Thieves, drunkards and criminals who had been punished.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Why do you think the eligibility conditions as above were fixed? How does it compare with the eligibility of members contesting elections nowadays?

MANAGING WATER, A PRIZED RESOURCE

Agriculture was one of the most important activities in the Chola kingdom and water was an important resource. There were some portions of the Chola kingdom that fell in a rain shadow region. Hence, Rajaraja built major reservoirs, lakes and canals to feed the different parts of the kingdom. There was no, drought during Rajaraja's reign. Going back in time to the 2nd century, remember that it was a Chola king, Raja Karikala Chola, who built the Kallanai dam. This dam stands strong even till today irrigating more than a million acres of land.

DID YOU KNOW?

"Uyyakondan Kaalvaai" is a canal built during Rajaraja's time. This canal was around 70kms long with more than 100 branches. This canal still exists but has been polluted by us in recent times!

VIBRANT INCLUSIVE SOCIETY, GRAND ARCHITECTURE & ART

Society flourished under Rajaraja Chola and his successors. Women held a very high position in the kingdom. Among other things, they served as judges of peace, land administrators and teachers. The grand architecture of the Cholas and the stupendous bronze sculptures are appreciated even after 1000 years. The Thanjavur Brihadeeshwara temple is one of the most famous temples that was built during Rajaraja's time. Built with more than 1,30,000 tons of granite, the Brihadeeshwara temple is dedicated to Brihadeeshwara (Shiva) and Periyanayaki (Parvati). One of the titles of Rajaraja was Sivapadasekaran.



Brihadeeshwara temple, Thanjavur

The main vimana is 216 feet tall with just the top dome weighing more than 80 tons. The sculptures are a treat to the eyes. The sculptures of 81 karanas (Bharatanatyam dancing postures) can be found here that show the evolution of fine arts like sculpting and dancing. Fine sculptures in bronze displayed the intricate workmanship of the artists of the Chola period. Chola bronzes are still considered a gold standard in the art world.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

1. How was 80 tons lifted to a height of 216 feet and placed on top of the vimana of the Brihadeeshwara temple?
2. Think about the ancient structures near your school or home and list down their age and their function. Discuss how these structures were planned and built to last for such a long time.



Chola bronze sculpture of Lord Nataraja

An ardent devotee of Lord Shiva, Rajaraja Chola was an inclusive and tolerant ruler. He was able to recover large portions of the holy Shaiva scriptures called the **Thevaram** and hence was referred to as **Thirumurai Kanda Cholan**. The murthis of the Nayanmar saints came to be included in temples during his rule and chanting of the hymns composed by Appar, Sundarar and Sambandar were started that continues till date. Large temples for Lord Vishnu were built from the proceeds of the royal family in many places. A Buddhist Chudamani vihara was constructed in Nagapattinam and Rajaraja donated an entire village called Anaimangalam to support the vihara. Jainism flourished under the Cholas. Rajaraja continued supporting all faiths of Bharat like the kings before him and this was continued after his time as well.

DID YOU KNOW?

Gangaikonda Cholapuram was the new capital of the Cholas established by Rajendra Chola I after conquering the mighty Pala empire. Commerating his victory, he brought water from river Ganga to consecrate the deities in this temple. He also brought the priests and scholars from Vangadesa to perform the Vedic rituals. The Brihadeeshwara Temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram was constructed as a replica of the temple at Thanjavur.



Brihadeeshwara temple, Gangaikonda Cholapuram

The Chola empire (848 CE -1280 CE) emerged as a major power during the reign of **Raja Raja Chola I** and **Rajendra Chola I** who were great warriors and conquerors. The Chola dynasty reigned over Southern Bharat, and expanded its territories by successful naval expeditions to parts of southeast Asia, Sri Lanka, the Maldives and Bengal in the 11th century. The Cholas were revered as protectors of Dharma and generous administrators. Southern portions of Bharat achieved excellence in art, architecture, literature and religion during Chola rule. Let us understand what happened in northern Bharat during the period.

INVASIONS RESUME, RESISTANCE CONTINUES

Islamic invasions resumed with Muhammad Ghori in the late 12th century. Muhammad Ghori was a Ghurid. Ghurids were vassals of the Ghaznavids who overthrew the Ghaznavids and established their rule going forward. Muhammad Ghori's first attempt to enter Bharat was via the Bolan Pass. Gujarat of that time was ruled by the Chaulukyas. Let us briefly look at the Chaulukyas.

DEFENCE BY THE CHAULUKYAS

The Chaulukyas dynasty, later known also the Solanki dynasty, ruled parts of present day Gujarat and Rajasthan in north-western Bharat, between 940 CE and 1244 CE. Their capital was located at Anahilavada (modern Patan, Gujarat). At their peak, their rule extended to the Malwa region in present-day Madhya Pradesh. They belonged to the Solanki clan of Rajputs and were great patrons of art and architecture. They constructed the awe-inspiring Dilwara Temples, Modhera Sun Temple and Rani Ki Vav in the style of Maru-Gurjara architecture.



Chaulukya Kingdom


Modhera Sun Temple


Rani Ki Vav

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Notice the intricate design of these temples and monuments built in the early 11th century by the Chaulukyas rulers. Is it possible to create such architectural marvels without machines? What kind of tools would the Chaulukyas have used?

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RANI NAYAKIDEVI'S MIGHT

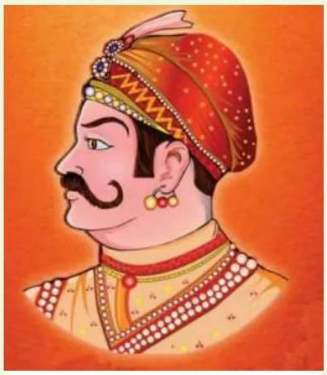
To capture Gujarat, Muhammad Ghori with a large army moved through the Thar desert (western Rajasthan) towards Anahilavada and reached the foothills of Mount Abu in 1178 CE. Muhammad chose to enter Bharat via Anahilavada as this region was ruled by a young prince. He was the Gujarat Chaulukyas king **Mularaja II**. His mother, **Rani Nayakidevi**, acted as his regent to rule the region. Muhammad assumed that he could easily capture a region ruled by a boy and administered by a woman. He severely underestimated the capabilities of Rani Nayakidevi. The Rani was skilled in sword fighting, cavalry, military strategy, diplomacy and all other subjects of statecraft. This was a very unique encounter where Mularaja II, still a small boy, was led to the battlefront by his mother, the valorous Rani Nayakidevi.

BATTLE OF KAYADARA	
When? 1178 CE	
Where? Kayadara, Gujarat	
Who were the combatants?	
Chaulukya	Ghurids
Who were the commanders?	
Rani Nayakidevi	Muhammad Ghori
Outcome : Retreat of Muhammad Ghori	
SIGNIFICANCE : Muhammad Ghori never returns to Gujarat	

At Kasahrada (Kayadara) in Sirohi Gujarat, Muhammad Ghori and his large army suffered a crushing defeat. Muhammad was so scarred by this defeat that he never dared to attack Gujarat again. Muhammad Ghori barely managed to escape to Ghazni.

ENCOUNTER WITH RAJA PRITHVIRAJ CHAUHAN

Prithiviraj was born in 1141 CE and ascended the throne in 1178 CE, after the death of his father Raja Someshwar Chauhan. Prithviraj was declared the heir to his maternal grandfather's throne as well because of his courage and sharp acumen. With this, Prithiviraj gained control over Delhi as well. His capital was located at Ajmer and his empire covered much of present-day Rajasthan, Haryana, Delhi, and some parts of Punjab, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. Prithviraj's territory extended from Thaneswar in the north to Jahazpur in the south.



Prithviraj Chauhan



When Ghori attacked and captured Sirhind, the local chieftains of Prithviraj informed him of the desecration of villages and attacks on women by Muhammad's army. Shocked by these reports Prithviraj headed out with a large army to put an end to the miseries of the people of Sirhind.

THE FIRST BATTLE OF TARAIN

In 1191 at Tarain (near Delhi), the two armies clashed. The vastly superior forces of Prithviraj quickly destroyed the army of Ghori. The speed with which Prithviraj had assembled his troops and attacked Sirhind caught Muhammad Ghori by surprise. The administrator of Delhi Govindaraja, was very effective in leading the attack on Muhammad.

BATTLE OF TARAIN 1	
When? 1191 CE	
Where? Tarori, Haryana	
Who were the combatants?	
Chauhans	Ghurids
Who were the commanders?	
Prithviraj Chauhan	Muhammad Ghori
Outcome : Prithviraj wins	
SIGNIFICANCE : A grave mistake to allow Ghori to flee which Bharat will repent	

In the fierce battle that followed Muhammad Ghori was severely wounded and had to be taken away from the battlefield by his soldiers. Ghori's army started retreating to save themselves. Muhammad Ghori and his important generals were almost captured by Prithviraj as they were fleeing the battlefield. However, Prithviraj did not want to chase and capture them as they had turned their backs and were running away. This was a mistake that Prithviraj and the rest of Bharat will repent*. Muhammad Ghori managed to escape to Ghor. Angry at his loss, Muhammad started putting together a large army.

THE SECOND BATTLE OF TARAIN

In 1192, Muhammad Ghori set forth towards Tarain once again to avenge the loss of the first battle. With an army of more than one lakh soldiers, he marched towards Delhi. However, as he got nearer to Tarain, Muhammad decided to use unethical tactics. He sent word to Prithviraj asking for a truce. Prithviraj lowered his guard and lowered the preparedness of his army. Early one morning when Prithviraj's men were still asleep, Muhammad Ghori struck. Caught unprepared, Prithviraj and his army suffered great losses. The speed and ferocity of Muhammad's army soon decimated

BATTLE OF TARAIN 2	
When? 1192 CE	
Where? Tarori, Haryana	
Who were the combatants?	
Chauhans	Ghurids
Who were the commanders?	
Prithviraj Chauhan	Muhammad Ghori
Outcome : Prithviraj loses	
SIGNIFICANCE : Most of northern Bharat falls into the hands of Islamic invaders. Rajputs greatly weakened.	

Repent : Feel sorry about

Prithviraj's army. There are varying accounts of what happened to Prithviraj. As per one of the accounts Prithviraj was captured and killed. However, the local history and folklore recall Chand Bardai's version.

Impact of the second battle of Tarain:

a. A large portion of northern India fell into the hands of the Islamic invaders from Ghor.
b. The Chahamana Rajputs were greatly weakened, and Rajput rule almost came to an end.
c. The confidence of the rulers of various regions in Bharat was shaken.
d. Muhammad Ghori proceeded to destroy and loot Ajmer, Hansi, Saraswati, Samna and Delhi. His slave and military general Qutbuddin ransacked Ayodhya in 1193 and razed temples which were the cornerstone of Hindu civilization.

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Was it right for Prithviraj to allow Muhammad Ghori and his army to leave? Being magnanimous to the enemy Vs protecting the nation from future invasions – discuss and debate which is the greater good.

PRITHVIRAJ RASO BY CHAND BARDAI

In the second battle of Tarain, Prithviraj was captured alive by Muhammad Ghori who took him to Ghor. Prithviraj's eyes were gouged out. At this shocking news, Chand Bardai, a poet to Prithiviraj went on his own to Muhammad's court. Chand Bardai submitted his request to him that, "I must be killed in the same or any other manner as my master. Secondly, I submit that the Sultan should himself witness a demonstration of exceptional archery skill of my master in the wonderful art of hitting an object, hearing to the sound it produces". This request made Muhammad curious about this wonderful art. Even then with every precaution, the necessary arrangements for the demonstration were made. Twenty-one pans were hung. Muhammad Ghori sat with his noblemen at a high place in the court to witness the feat. Chand Bardai and Prithviraj were made to sit before the pans with heavy security. As soon as the sound rang out the blinded Prithviraj took an unmistakable aim at the pan concerned and hit the mark. As this feat was repeated with exceptional accuracy for twenty-one times, the whole court was thrilled with wonder. Muhammad himself couldn't hold back praising Prithviraj's skill and exclaimed "Wah Wah". At that very moment, the captive Chand Bardai sitting near Prithviraj composed a couplet on the spot, guiding Prithviraj to shoot, without wasting a moment. The blinded Prithviraj took aim in the direction of the sound made by Muhammad Ghori and killed him with a sharp arrow. At once there was an uproar and confusion everywhere, but before the guards of the Sultan could fall upon them with their weapons, Prithviraj and Chand Bardai drew out their own swords and cut off their own heads!

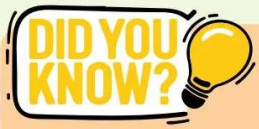
LESSONS THE KINGS NEVER LEARNT

Many kings of Bharat had still not learnt their lesson. They were steeped in their tradition of tolerance. Jayasimha Siddharaja (1094-1143 CE) punished his people for interfering with the worship of the invaders. Different Sufi teachers carried out conversion activities–Mumin Arif near Devagiri (which was under the Yadavas) and Jalaluddin Ganjrawan were some of the Sufis of the time. Sarangadeva (1294-1297 CE) granted money for building a mosque in Prabhas Patan with the blessing of the Somnath priest!

EMERGENCE OF THE SLAVE DYNASTY (MAMLUK)

Within two years after winning the Battle of Tarain, Muhammad Ghori, fearing repulsion from the Hindu rulers, chose to not remain seated in Delhi but to return to Ghazni, his hometown. In 1206, Muhammad Ghori appointed Qutbuddin as the Naib* of his empire. He came to be known as Qutbuddin Aibak. This marked the beginning of the Slave dynasty and the Delhi Sultanate.

The Delhi Sultanate that was established ensured that Islam assumed political power. The rulers differentiated between the people of Bharat and the foreign mercenaries* that they brought along with them. Conversion activities were rampant-by allurement* and the sword. Hindus were denied their right to worship, right to basic civil rights and dignities. Some communities converted to the new religion for royal favour or protection. Although many compromises had to be made by the Hindus, they still held on to their beliefs and spirituality.



The famous Qutb Minar complex supposedly constructed by Qutbuddin Aibak and other subsequent sultans was a temple dedicated to Lord Vishnu. Remains of about 27 destroyed Hindu and Jain temples were used to construct this complex. The Minar was a Vishnusthamba of the Gupta Period. The images below show temple pillars and motifs that can be seen even today at the Qutb Minar complex.







Source: Muslim historian Maulana Hakim Syed Abdul Hai and Archaeological Survey of India.

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SOLANKIS DRIVE OUT QUTBUDDIN AIBAK

Between 1194 and 1195, a large group of tribal people from Mehr sought the help of the Chaulukya king **Bhima II** to expel the Turks from Rajputana. They joined hands and attacked the army of Aibak. Unable to withstand this combined onslaught Aibak withdrew his troops. However, in 1197, Aibak attacked the Chaulukyas with extra troops. Aibak won and installed a governor and returned to Delhi. In 1201 CE Bhima reorganized himself and drove the Turks out of Gujarat gradually. They continued to defend their territories from Iltutmish, the successor of Aibak, and other subsequent rulers of the Delhi Sultanate, until it was ultimately overrun by Alauddin Khalji.

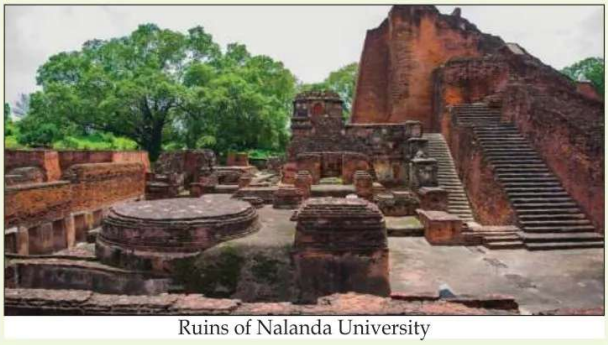
RISE AND FALL OF BAKHTIYAR KHALJI

Bakhtiyar Khalji was a soldier in Awadh province's army. Wanting to gain prominence, he set his eyes on the Magadha territory (present day Bihar). He attacked the famous Nalanda University and mercilessly slaughtered thousands of innocent Buddhists and Hindus. He demolished the university and burnt down the university library, which burnt for over 3 months. He also ravaged other universities like Odantapuri and Vikramashila. From there he proceeded to Bengal and defeated the Sena king Lakshmanasena.

Naib : A person who is second in command, after the King
Mercenary : Warrior
Allurement : To attract by bribing

CLASSROOM DISCUSSION

Why would someone want to attack students and teachers at a university?
What do the attackers gain by destroying large libraries filled with rare and important books?



Ruins of Nalanda University

BAKHTIYAR KHALJI BAITED

In 1206 CE, Bakhtiyar passed through Assam with an army of about 12,000 men towards Tibet. **Raja Prithu** of the Kamarupa dynasty, intentionally let Bakhtiyar pass through his empire without offering any resistance. Raja Prithu strategised and destroyed every resource of the region that fell along the route taken by Bakhtiyar Khalji. Upon reaching Tibet, Bakhtiyar Khalji and his army were shocked on seeing a huge army waiting to attack them and so he decided to retreat. But while returning through the Kamarupa region, the invading army found that they had no resources like food crops, shelter, etc. A huge dam that the army used to cross a river was also found broken. Taken by surprise, Bakhtiyar and his men took shelter at a nearby temple. Raja Prithu waiting for this moment launched a surprise attack and vanquished the army of Bakhtiyar Khalji. Bakhtiyar along with a few men escaped from the place and reached Bengal. Bakthiyar Khalji after suffering a catastrophic* defeat was crushed and broken and never led any campaign thereafter. He went into depression and was ultimately assassinated by another general named Ali Mardan.

BATTLE OF KAMARUPA	
When? 1206 CE	
Where? Kamarupa, Assam	
Who were the combatants?	
Kamarupa empire	Delhi Sultanate
Who were the commanders?	
Raja Prithu	Bakhtiyar Khalji
Outcome : Decimation of Bakhtiyar Khalji and his army	
SIGNIFICANCE : Led to Bakhtiyar Khalji's ultimate end	

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DID YOU KNOW?

After Kamarupa dynasty, the northeast provinces (present day Assam and northeastern states) were ruled by a dynasty called Ahoms. They challenged all invasions and maintained the sovereignty of Assam for the next 600 years until 1826 !!!

CONCLUSION

The Cholas flourished under Rajaraja and under his son Rajendra Chola, the Chola empire reached its greatest heights. Andhra, parts of Madhya Pradesh, Bengal, Orissa (Odisha) and Bihar, Sri Lanka and most parts of South Asia came under Chola rule. Art, literature, architecture, and society flourished. Major contributions were also made in philosophy, drama, music, and dance.

Northern Bharat came under attack from Islamic invaders that were driven away by brave rulers and warriors. However, this also meant that the normal way of life was impacted and rulers started concentrating on just their regions. Through the heroic deeds of Bharatiyas like Jayapaladeva, Raja Bhoja, Rani Nayakidevi, Raja Suheldev and Prithviraj Chauhan, Bharat was able to retain its cultural roots.

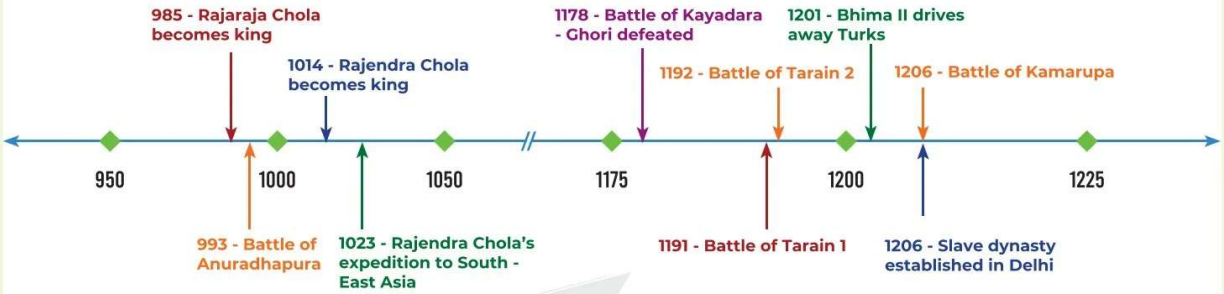
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Catastrophic : Disastrous

KEYWORDS

- Rajaraja Chola
- Kandalur Salai
- Dvipantara Bharata
- Ship building
- Sea navigation
- Kudavolai system
- Chola bronze
- Brihadeeshwara
- Gangaikonda Cholapuram
- Rajendra Chola
- Chaulukyas
- Battle of Kayadara
- Rani Nayakidevi
- Prithviraj Chauhan
- Battle of Tarain
- Mamluk Dynasty
- Bakhtiyar Khalji
- Raja Prithu
- Muhammad Ghori

RECAP WITH TIMESCALE



QUESTIONS

MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. Which of the following places did Rajaraja Chola **NOT** rule over?
   a) Kollam b) Madurai c) Jagannathamangalam d) Kalyani
2. _____ was called a Chola lake.
   a) Bay of Bengal b) Indian Ocean c) Arabian Sea d) River Kaveri
3. True or False

Statement A :Rajendra Chola recovered large portions of the Shaiva literature called the Thevaram.
Statement B : Rajaraja Chola donated an entire village called Anaimangalam to support the Buddhist Vihara.
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) Both are false d) A & B are true

4. True or False

Statement A : Qutbuddin Aibak built the Qutb Minar from temple ruins
Statement B : Qutbuddin Aibak was the first king of the Delhi Sultanate
   a) A alone is true b) B alone is true c) Both are false d) A & B are true
5. _____ was the Chaulukyan ruler who defeated Qutbuddin Aibak.
   a) Prithviraj Chauhan b) Nayakidevi c) Bhima II d) Suheldev
6. Who got the title Kadaram Kondan?
   a) Rajaraja Chola b) Rajendra Chola c) Kulothunga Chola d) Mahinda V

ANSWER IN BRIEF

1. What were the main sources of revenue for the Cholas?
2. What is special about the temple at Gangaikonda Cholapuram?
3. What was the role of a Naduvirikkai in the Chola administration?
4. What was the impact of the Second Battle of Tarain?
5. What can we learn about Prithviraj from the Prithviraj Raso retold by Chand Bardai?

ANSWER IN DETAIL

1. Why were the Cholas called the naval superpower? Explain their achievements in the field of shipping with examples.
2. What are the key features of the Kudavolai system of elections? Why were such eligibility criteria chosen?
3. Give examples to explain the social and religious life during the Chola times.
4. Who fought the Battle of Kayadara? If not for this battle, what would have happened?
5. What was the result of the First Battle of Tarain? Why did Prithviraj allow the enemy to retreat? How did this decision cost him?
6. What damage did Bakhtiyar Khalji cause to Bharat? How was he baited and defeated?

PICTURE BASED QUESTIONS



1. Identify the structure. Where is it?
2. Which dynasty built this piece of work?
3. Which deity is this place dedicated to?



1. Identify the structure. Where is it?
2. Who built it?
3. Explain 3 salient features of this temple.

CASE STUDY

In the fierce Battle of Tarain I (1191), Muhammad Ghori was severely wounded and had to be taken away from the battlefield by his soldiers. The attack on the invaders was very powerful that Ghori's army started retreating to save themselves. It is said that the top commanders and Muhammad Ghori were close to being captured by Prithviraj Chauhan as they were fleeing the battlefield. However, Prithviraj Chauhan did not want to chase and capture Muhammad and his generals as they had turned their backs and were fleeing. This was a mistake that Prithviraj Chauhan and the rest of Bharat will stand to repent. Muhammad Ghori managed to escape to Ghor. Angry at his loss, Muhammad put together a large army and came back to attack Prithviraj Chauhan in 1192.

1. Why did Prithviraj allow the enemy to retreat? What was the result of his action?
2. What were the strengths and weaknesses of Prithviraj Chauhan as a king?
3. What could have Prithviraj done differently so that Battle of Tarain II (1192) could have been avoided?

MAP WORK

Mark the following places on the outline map of India.

- any 2 seaports of the Cholas
- the capital of Rajaraja Chola
- the battlefield where Rani Nayakidevi defeated Muhammad Ghori
- Raja Prithu's kingdom